

MADHYA PRADESH BOOSTING ART & CULTURE

The soil of Madhya Pradesh has been imbued in traits of art and culture from time immemorial. It has seen the efflorescence of great traditions of art, music, literature, architecture, painting and other art forms.

This Heartland State of India has produced great poets like Kalidas, Bhavbhuti, Bhṛīhārī, Bhoj, Bihārī, Isurī, Keshav and others who greatly contributed to enrichment of Indian literature.

Madhya Pradesh is identified with great musicians like Tansen, Baijubavra, Ustad Alauddin Khan, Ustad Hafiz Ali, Pandit Krishna Rao Shankar Pandit, Ustad Haleem Zafar, Ustad Ziauddin Dagar, Pandit Vishnu Narayan Bhatkhande, Kumar Gandharva, Asgari Bai, Ustad Amir Khan, to name a few.

Madhya Pradesh is proud of producing great painters like D.J. Joshi, Syed Haider Raza, N.S. Bendre, Vishnu Bhatnagar, M.F. Hussain, Amritlal Begad, Vishnu Chinchalkar and Guru Devlalikar.

The state is also dotted with sites of great archaeological and historical importance and temples of unmatched grandeur. It boasts of having three world heritage sites in Khajuraho, Sanchi and Bhimbetka.

Madhya Pradesh truly represents the carnival spirit of Indian culture with myriad of folk art tradition.

To preserve and further enrich the great heritage of the state is naturally one of the prime and paramount responsibilities of the state Government.

Any negligence or laxity on the part of the Government may lead to erosion of the great art tradition.

The present State Government in Madhya Pradesh led by an energetic and culturally alive youthful Chief Minister Shri Shivraj Singh Chouhan, has given a good account of itself in this regard.

Well conceived steps have been taken over last four and half years to encourage artists and provide them better opportunities and facilities to groom and display their respective arts.

Recently, the Chief Minister announced doubling of the amount of National and State Level Awards instituted by the State Government.



In a major initiative, the art and cultural activities have been decentralized to district level and even below. Earlier, these were confined to the state capital and to some extent, big cities. The culture department of the State has started Annual Narmada Festival at Jabalpur, Betwa Festival in Vidisha, Dharohar Utsav in Gwalior, Virasat Utsav at Chhatarpur and Bhojpur Utsav at Bhojpur besides festivals at other places including Garh Kunder, Chhindwara etc.

In order to showcase the kaleidoscopic great art and culture of Madhya Pradesh at national level "Madhya Pradesh Golden Jubilee Festivals" were organized in New Delhi, Lucknow, Patna and Mumbai. These featured performances of classical music, dances and traditional arts.

At the initiative of the Chief Minister a music festival has been started in Gwalior in memory of great musician Pandit Krishna Rao Shankar Pandit and Udaipur Utsav at Udaipur from this year.

Celebrating the ancient tradition of India Vikramotsava was organized at Ujjain on Varsha Pratipad. Nav Samvatsar was also organized at other places.

To the great joy of Ram Lila lovers an international Ram Lila Mela was organized recently at Bhopal. Ram Lila troupes from Cambodia, Bali, Sri Lanka, Singapore, Jawa and Laos participated in it.

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A national Ramaya multipurpose cultur are being construct same in Indore, Vi Shodh Sanstha, Ch

